

6 System Life Cycle Processes

6.1 Agreement Processes

The Agreement Processes establish and maintain mutual commitments between the acquirer and the supplier. They include the Acquisition Process and the Supply Process. This clause focuses on the Acquisition Process.

6.1.1 Purpose

The purpose of the Acquisition Process is to obtain a product or service that satisfies the acquirer's needs, in accordance with organizational policies and applicable standards. This process begins with the identification of customer needs and ends with the acceptance and closure of the acquisition agreement.

6.1.2 Outcomes

As a result of successful implementation of the Acquisition Process:

- a) An acquisition strategy and plan are developed that clearly define expectations, responsibilities, liabilities, and acceptance criteria for both the acquirer and the supplier.**
 - b) One or more suppliers are selected according to defined procedures.**
 - c) A contract or agreement is established between the acquirer and the supplier.**
 - d) The acquired product or service meets the acquirer's stated requirements, constraints (cost, schedule, quality), and acceptance criteria.**
 - e) Supplier performance is monitored against contract milestones, deliverables, and quality measures.**
 - f) Acceptance is conducted according to defined strategy and criteria, with verification and validation evidence gathered.**
 - g) All contractual and technical issues are satisfactorily closed, and the acquirer assumes configuration management responsibility for the delivered product.**
-

6.1.3 Activities and Tasks

The project shall implement the following activities and tasks in accordance with organizational policies and procedures.

6.1.3.1 Acquisition Preparation

This activity involves defining the acquisition need, analyzing requirements, and preparing the acquisition plan.

- 6.1.3.1.1 Describe the concept or need to acquire, develop, or enhance a system, software product, or software service.
 - 6.1.3.1.2 Define and analyze system and/or software requirements, including business, organizational, user, safety, security, and criticality requirements, referencing Stakeholder Requirements Definition (6.4.2) and System Requirements Analysis (6.4.3).
 - 6.1.3.1.3 Analyze acquisition options based on risk, cost, benefit, and feasibility, including:
 - Use of off-the-shelf software products
 - Internal development
 - Contracted development or service provision
 - Enhancement of existing software products or services
 - Combinations of the above
 - 6.1.3.1.4 Ensure that off-the-shelf acquisitions meet requirements for documentation, licensing, warranty, future support, and proprietary rights.
 - 6.1.3.1.5 Prepare, document, and execute an acquisition plan including requirements, contract type, responsibilities, support concept, risk considerations, and management methods.
 - 6.1.3.1.6 Define and document the acceptance strategy and criteria.
 - 6.1.3.1.7 Document acquisition requirements (e.g., RFP), including system/software requirements, scope, bidder instructions, software list, terms and conditions, subcontract control, and technical constraints.
 - 6.1.3.1.8 Tailor relevant International Standard processes as needed and define scope of tasks referencing the contract.
 - 6.1.3.1.9 Define contract milestones for reviews and audits (see 7.2.6 and 7.2.7).
-

6.1.3.2 Acquisition Advertisement

This activity involves announcing the acquisition and soliciting responses.

- 6.1.3.2.1 Request products or services from identified suppliers.

- 6.1.3.2.2 Engage in supply chain partnership to align technical and commercial approaches.
-

6.1.3.3 Supplier Selection

This activity involves evaluating proposals and selecting a supplier.

- 6.1.3.3.1 Establish a supplier selection procedure with evaluation criteria and compliance weighting.
 - 6.1.3.3.2 Evaluate proposals based on capability, technical compliance, acceptance strategy, and conditions.
 - 6.1.3.3.3 Select supplier(s) accordingly.
-

6.1.3.4 Contract Agreement

This activity establishes formal agreements with the supplier.

- 6.1.3.4.1 Involve relevant parties (e.g., suppliers, regulators) to tailor standard requirements for the project.
- 6.1.3.4.2 Negotiate and prepare a contract that includes acquisition requirements, cost, schedule, proprietary and licensing rights, and quality expectations.
- 6.1.3.4.3 Establish a change control mechanism for contract modifications, analyzing their impact on plans, costs, benefits, quality, and schedule.
- 6.1.3.4.4 Determine whether to apply the term “contract” or “agreement” per organizational policy.
- 6.1.3.4.5 Express expectations and responsibilities clearly, including the level of formality for change requests.

Informative Annex F provides a sample contract change management process.

6.1.3.5 Agreement Monitoring

This activity monitors supplier performance and contract fulfillment.

- 6.1.3.5.1 Monitor supplier activities using review (7.2.6), audit (7.2.7), verification (7.2.4), and validation (7.2.5) processes as appropriate.
- 6.1.3.5.2 Cooperate with the supplier to provide necessary

information and resolve pending issues in a timely manner.

6.1.3.6 Acquirer Acceptance

This activity ensures that the delivered product or service meets acceptance criteria.

- **6.1.3.6.1 Prepare for acceptance based on the defined strategy and criteria, including test cases, data, procedures, and environment.**
 - **6.1.3.6.2 Conduct acceptance reviews and testing, referring to System Qualification Testing (6.4.6) and/or Software Qualification Testing (7.1.7).**
 - **6.1.3.6.3 Accept the deliverable when all acceptance conditions are met.**
 - **6.1.3.6.4 Assume configuration management responsibility post-acceptance (see 7.2.2).**
-

6.1.3.7 Closure

This activity concludes the acquisition.

- **6.1.3.7.1 Ensure all contractual obligations are met and issues resolved.**
- **6.1.3.7.2 Process payments or other agreed considerations for products or services rendered.**
- **6.1.3.7.3 Handle incremental deliveries and payments as applicable.**